



Introduction

As far as we know, Earth is the only planet that supports life. This book celebrates some of the millions of living things that call it home, as well as the rocks, fossils, and other natural marvels that make up our world. All of them are amazing and beautiful in their own different way, from glittering gems and tiny organisms smaller than a full stop, to towering trees and giant sharks. This book is divided into four sections: Rocks and minerals; Microscopic life; Plants; and Animals. Together, they reveal the fantastic variety of life on Earth. Our planet is full of wonders of nature, including many we do not yet understand, and many others we have yet to discover.



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